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Bankable:

Understanding Offshore Wind Auction Stakeholders
through Large Language Model Personas



August 2026

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Interactive.li turns the models behind energy, economic, environmental and health policy into live sessions in which participants take the decisions themselves, compare their results, and see the trade-offs each choice involves.

Inquiries: contact@interactive.li

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Contents

Introduction	4
Caution: Simulated Feedback - For Educational Purposes Only	5
Context and Relevance	6
Introduction to Offshore Wind Auctions in Emerging Markets	6
The Prevailing Model of Risk Allocation	6
Consequences Beyond Price	8
The Stakeholder Landscape	8
Why Stakeholder Understanding is Essential.....	9
<i>Bankable</i> : Understanding Offshore Wind Auction Stakeholders through LLM Personas....	10
Purpose of the Serious Game	10
Educational and Policy Relevance	10
Gamification Approach.....	10
Appendices.....	15
Appendix 1: Key Stakeholders	15
Finance Ministry	15
Energy Ministry	15
State Utility	15
Independent Regulator	16
International Offshore Wind Developer	16
Development Finance Institution.....	16
Coastal Communities and Fishing Industry	16
Domestic Industry and Supply Chain Advocate.....	17
Appendix 2: Serious Game Levels.....	17
Round 1: Enabling Conditions - Building the Ground Before the Auction	17
Round 2: Qualification and Selection - Deciding Who Competes and Who Wins.....	19
Round 3: Remuneration and Risk - Making the Project Bankable.....	20
Round 4: Shock and Response - Testing What You Built.....	21
Epilogue: Ten Years On - The Verdict	23
Round 5: Post-Award Accountability - What the Design Deferred	23
Bibliography.....	24
Disclosure: Use of AI Technologies	25

Introduction

Live survey applications are now commonplace in schools, meeting rooms, and conferences. These apps offer various question formats, enabling the collection of data through multiple-choice polls, open-ended questions, and rankings, promoting active participation, and allowing presenters to tailor their communication based on real-time audience insights.

Interactive.li is a live survey platform tailored to the needs of training and communication professionals. It uses generative AI to automatically summarise and analyse audience feedback, helping to overcome cultural and language barriers while providing real-time insights. The platform also features gamification and model-based simulation, allowing participants to learn by doing in a safe, structured environment - and to enjoy the process along the way (Figure 1).

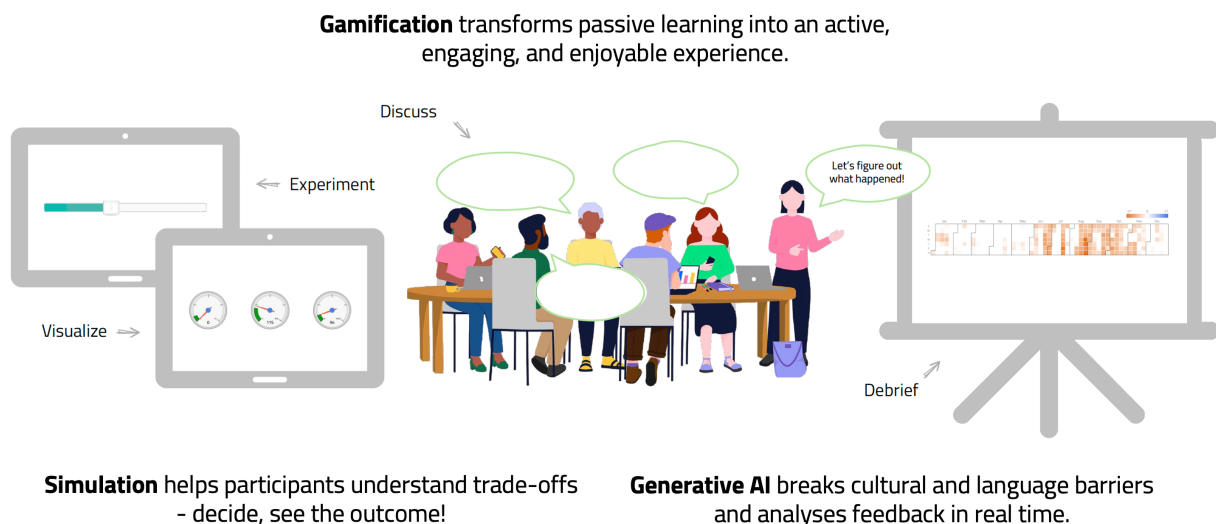


Figure 1: Interactive.li Platform Building-Blocks

These innovative features significantly improve the user experience for both instructors and participants, ultimately leading to more effective training workshops and communication campaigns.

This report provides a technical description of *Bankable*, an Interactive.li-based serious game aimed at exploring and understanding stakeholder roles in offshore wind auction design in emerging markets with Large Language Model (LLM) personas. In the game, participants assume the role of the auction designer - the government authority responsible for structuring a competitive procurement process - making decisions at key stages of the programme and receiving feedback from simulated stakeholder groups. Stakeholder responses are generated by LLM personas instructed with contextual

information, the scenario's policy framework, as well as each group's specific interests, expectations, and legal responsibilities.

The aim of the game is not to identify optimal auction designs, but to raise awareness of the complexity involved in allocating risk, the need for trade-offs, and the importance of aligning diverse perspectives.

Bankable was designed to spark dialogue, promote critical thinking, and encourage reflection on how decisions are framed and negotiated. To enhance the realism and relevance of the simulation, the game is set in a fictional but realistic emerging market country and grounded in publicly available sources. The early experience of countries launching their first offshore wind auctions provides a compelling basis for exploring stakeholder dynamics in depth.

The learning experience is also intended to be playful and engaging. As they progress through different stages of the game, players collect points based on how well their decisions are received by different stakeholders. The winner is the player with the highest score at the end. However, players must also avoid getting a stakeholder veto, which results in an immediate "game over".

Caution: Simulated Feedback - For Educational Purposes Only

The stakeholder personas featured in *Bankable* are fictional representations created for educational and illustrative purposes. They are generic composite roles - a finance ministry, an energy ministry, a state utility, an independent regulator, an international offshore wind developer, a development finance institution, coastal communities and the fishing industry, and a domestic industry and supply chain advocate - and are not affiliated with, endorsed by, or intended to represent the official positions of any real-world government, institution, company, or community. The country in which the exercise is set is fictional and is not intended to represent any real country. All AI-generated responses used in this game are simulations and should not be interpreted as factual statements, policy recommendations, or official communications.

LLMs can sometimes "hallucinate" - that is, generate inaccurate or misleading information - because they rely on predicting patterns rather than retrieving verified facts. While care has been taken to ensure the content reflects known legal and institutional frameworks, no guarantee is given regarding its accuracy or completeness.

Context and Relevance

Introduction to Offshore Wind Auctions in Emerging Markets

Auctions - or competitive procurement - have become the leading instrument for deploying renewable power worldwide, and are expected to drive close to 60% of gross capacity additions between 2025 and 2030. Their appeal lies in real price discovery, which reduces the information asymmetry between governments and market players, and in the flexibility of their design, which allows them to be tailored to particular contexts, challenges, and policy objectives. There is no one-size-fits-all model: each context requires its own design.

Offshore wind places this instrument under unusual strain. Projects are considerably more capital-intensive than onshore wind or solar; the supply chain for turbines, foundations, installation vessels, and subsea cables is concentrated among a small number of international manufacturers; and the pool of developers able to deliver at scale is small and selective about where it commits capital. For a government preparing its first offshore wind auction, these conditions narrow the design space considerably. Table 1 summarises the design elements available to auction designers and the categories of risk each one allocates.

The Prevailing Model of Risk Allocation

Global investment in renewable energy reached a record USD 807 billion in 2024, but its distribution is stark. Emerging markets and developing economies outside the G20 received less than 10% of that total, and sub-Saharan Africa less than 3%. Where investment is perceived as high risk, auctions have typically been designed to move risk away from bidders and towards the offtaker and the government - through sovereign guarantees, power purchase agreements denominated in hard currency, and award criteria based largely on the lowest price submitted.

In the short term, this model works. It gives investors certainty over their revenue, increases their willingness to participate, and delivers competitive prices, particularly where development finance institutions lend their capital and credibility. Over a longer horizon it is costly. Guarantees create contingent liabilities that affect sovereign debt metrics if they are called; hard currency contracts expose the public balance sheet to depreciation for the life of the agreement; and a design optimised for the lowest price alone may perpetuate reliance on imported equipment, finance, and expertise, with little value retained in the domestic economy.

Category	Design elements	Principal risks allocated
Auction demand and demand-side responsibilities	Volume and frequency; auctioned product; choice of offtaker; allocation of costs; contracting scheme	Policy and regulatory; currency; market; technology; counterparty; grid and transmission; construction; force majeure
Location, technology and project specifications	Location specificity; technology specificity; project size limits; project specificity; production limits; socio-economic requirements	Site provision and preparation; social and environmental; permitting; grid and transmission; resource; technology; supply chain; construction
Qualification requirements and compliance rules	Reputational documentation; project development documentation; compliance rules	Technology; construction; financing or refinancing; supply chain; permitting; arbitration and contract enforcement
Winner selection	Selection criteria; provisions to prevent market concentration; price caps	Arbitration and contract enforcement; grid and transmission; supply chain; construction; counterparty; financing or refinancing
Risk allocation and remuneration of sellers	Contract duration; lead time; remuneration model; currency denomination; contract indexation; curtailment and transmission delays	Policy and regulatory; counterparty; market; currency; supply chain; grid and transmission; construction
Provisions for end of contract	Asset ownership; post-PPA options; decommissioning responsibility	Policy and regulatory; counterparty; financing or refinancing; market; arbitration and contract enforcement

Table 1: Auction Design Elements and the Categories of Risk They Allocate
Based on IRENA's renewable energy auction design framework

Consequences Beyond Price

Every auction design choice is simultaneously a risk allocation decision. Whether the state pre-develops the site or leaves siting to bidders, whether contracts are denominated in hard or local currency, whether winners are selected on price alone or against multiple criteria - each choice determines which party carries which risk, and each has consequences that extend well beyond the price bid.

Those consequences are not confined to the project. They reach the government's fiscal position, the affordability of electricity for consumers, the prospects for a domestic supply chain, and the social and environmental conditions in the communities that host the infrastructure. Mitigating a risk does not make it disappear; it moves it to another party, who prices it, absorbs it, or eventually declines to carry it. What counts as a fair allocation varies with every context, but it ultimately involves matching risks to the parties best able to manage them, while preserving the incentives that bring capable developers to the table in the first place.

The Stakeholder Landscape

An offshore wind auction assembles a distinctive cast of actors, and one that differs meaningfully from the stakeholder landscape of onshore renewable procurement. Within government, the Finance Ministry carries the fiscal consequences of any guarantee issued in the name of the state, while the Energy Ministry sponsors the programme and is accountable for delivering capacity against national targets. The State Utility is the likely offtaker and grid connection authority, and its balance sheet largely determines how credible the revenue stream appears to bidders. The Independent Regulator rules on the legality of the procurement and the resulting tariff, carrying a duty towards the consumers who ultimately pay for whatever is not borne by the treasury. Outside government, the International Offshore Wind Developer allocates capital across a global pipeline and can simply decline to bid, while the Development Finance Institution supplies the concessional capital and credit enhancement that commercial lenders are reluctant to provide in unproven markets. Coastal Communities and the Fishing Industry hold the social licence on which permits and timetables depend, and the Domestic Industry and Supply Chain Advocate speaks for the ports, fabricators, logistics operators, and engineering firms that could capture value from the programme if the auction design deliberately allows for it.

A full list of stakeholder groups represented in *Bankable* is included in Appendix 1.

Why Stakeholder Understanding is Essential

Understanding the interests and constraints of each of these groups is essential, because offshore wind auction design is not a technical optimisation problem. It is a political economy problem embedded in an institutional coordination challenge. The number of public entities whose alignment is required - covering maritime spatial planning, environmental permitting, port development, grid connection, local consent, and auction administration - is larger than for any comparable clean energy technology, and each operates on its own timetable and under its own mandate (Appendix 1).

The international dimension is more acute as well, drawing international developers, lenders, and equipment suppliers into a long-term relationship with host country governments and communities. And the consequences of a poor design are harder to reverse: a flawed onshore solar auction can be corrected in the next round, whereas a failed offshore wind round can set a programme back by years, because the developers who declined to bid do not return quickly. Officials who understand these trade-offs intellectually still frequently discover, in exercises of this kind, that they have been operating with incompatible assumptions about who was carrying which risk. Making those assumptions visible in a low-stakes setting is considerably less costly than discovering them in a live procurement.

Bankable: Understanding Offshore Wind Auction Stakeholders through LLM Personas

Purpose of the Serious Game

Bankable is a serious game that simulates how various stakeholders (Appendix 1) might respond to decisions made in the design of an offshore wind auction in an emerging market. As part of the game, players assume the role of the cross-government auctioning authority and advance through four decision rounds (Appendix 2), making design choices and observing the simulated responses of stakeholder groups. The game is designed to explore how these choices interact with the diverse interests, responsibilities, and expectations of eight key stakeholder groups. *Bankable* highlights that every auction design choice is simultaneously a risk allocation decision - one that shifts burdens and benefits between government, investors, utilities, communities, and consumers.

Educational and Policy Relevance

The game serves both as an educational resource and a policy simulation tool. For educators, it offers a structured, interactive method to explore themes such as risk allocation, fiscal sustainability, bankability, and the principles of a just transition. For policy practitioners and researchers, it provides an opportunity to examine the framing and perception of decisions across different stakeholder groups. Built on IRENA's renewable energy auction design framework, the game allows for a grounded understanding of competitive procurement and invites reflection on the broader challenges of financing the energy transition in emerging markets.

Gamification Approach

Bankable is based on the principles of discovery-based learning. During the interactive session, players are invited to make design decisions at key points in the auction design process. Each decision triggers dynamic feedback from simulated stakeholder personas, powered by LLMs, allowing participants to get a sense of what could be the fiscal, commercial, and social implications of their choices.

The game integrates eight distinct stakeholder personas, reflecting the key actors in an offshore wind auction governance landscape: the Finance Ministry, the Energy Ministry, the State Utility, the Independent Regulator, the International Offshore Wind Developer, the Development Finance Institution, Coastal Communities and the Fishing Industry, and

the Domestic Industry and Supply Chain Advocate (Appendix 1). Each persona represents not only an institutional role but also a set of expectations, concerns, and priorities grounded in commercial logic, legal mandate, and public interest.

Stakeholder responses are generated by LLM personas that have been instructed to simulate reactions based on two factors: (1) the auctioning authority's decision at each round, and (2) the group's identity, role, interests, core concerns, and non-negotiable positions. The goal is not to predict real-world behaviour, but to reflect the reasoning, concerns, and communication styles of actual stakeholders. Each persona speaks in the register of the institution it represents: the Finance Ministry in the language of fiscal risk and contingent liabilities, the developer in the language of internal rate of return and risk-adjusted cost of capital, the coastal community in the language of livelihoods and marine heritage.

Feedback is structured using a layered system that combines visual, quantitative, and qualitative elements. A traffic-light visualisation provides immediate signals: Green Light indicates strong support, Wait suggests conditional or cautious agreement, and Full Stop reflects clear opposition (Figure 2).

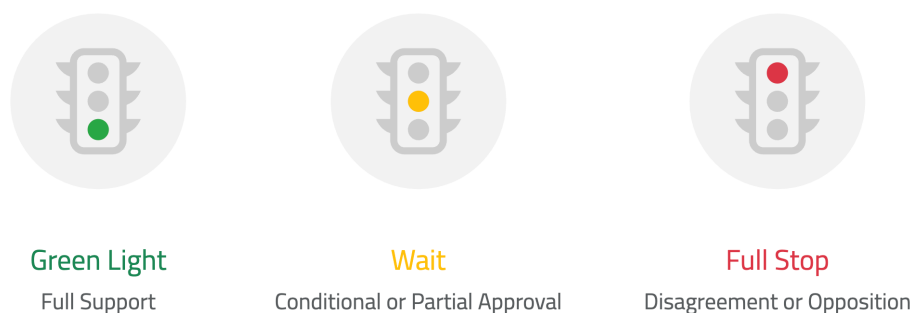


Figure 2: Traffic Light Signals

Each response is accompanied by a satisfaction index, rated from 0 to 10, which measures how well the participant's decision aligns with the stakeholder's expectations. As the game progresses, players accumulate points based on these scores, which ultimately help determine the winner (Figure 3).

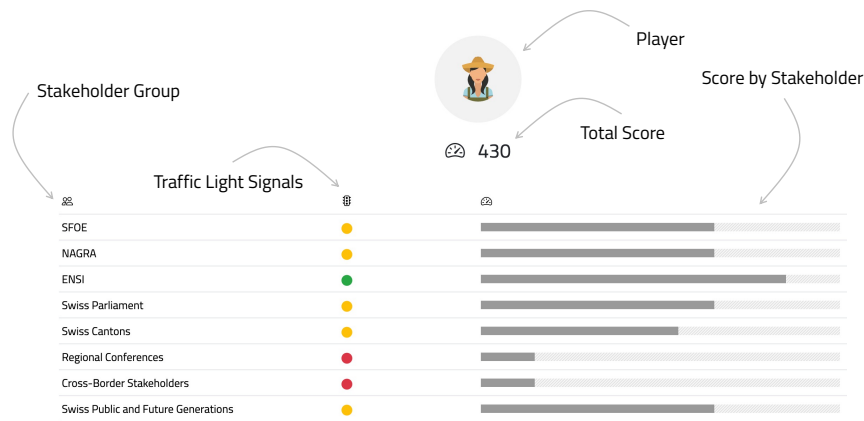


Figure 3: Score Build-up Example

The stakeholder feedback also includes concise, tailored explanations in the form of bullet points marked with ✓ if supportive, ✗ if critical, or 💡 if offering a suggestion for improvement (Figure 4).

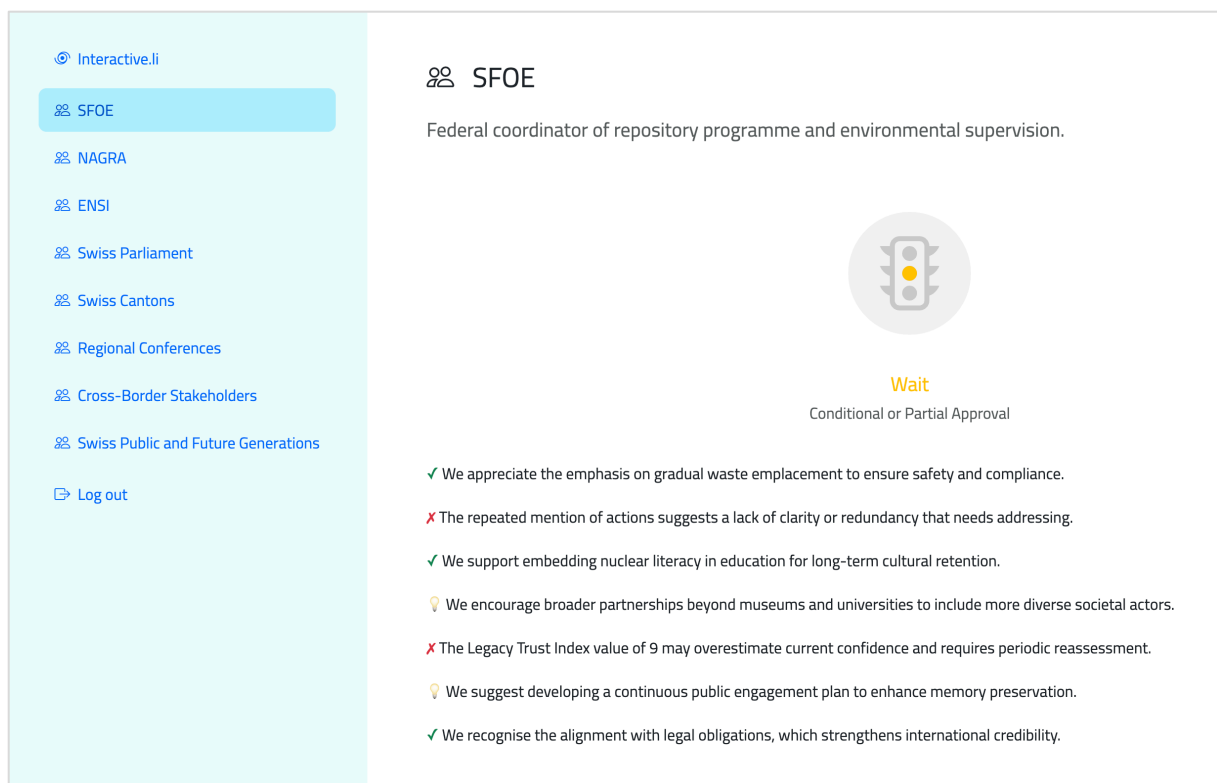


Figure 4: Stakeholder Feedback Example

Alongside the stakeholder feedback, a risk allocation map is displayed and updated in real time throughout the session. It shows which party is bearing which category of risk as a result of the player's cumulative design choices - political, currency, offtaker, grid

connection, supply chain, community, and fiscal risk - and how that distribution shifts from one round to the next. Consumers appear on the map as a risk-bearing party alongside the government, the utility, and the developer, since costs that are not carried by the treasury are recovered through the tariff. The map translates the logic of the auction design framework into something participants can see and respond to directly (Table 2).

Risk	Government	State utility	Developer	DFI	Consumers	Host communities
Political	●			◐		
Currency	●	◐			◐	
Offtaker	●	◐		◐		
Grid connection	●	◐				
Supply chain			●			
Community and environmental			◐			●
Fiscal	●			○	◐	

● Carries the risk ◐ Shares it ○ Residual exposure
 blank = not exposed

Table 2: Risk Allocation Map

The game is structured across four rounds reflecting the sequence that offshore wind auction designers actually face:

1. Enabling Conditions, where the state decides what it prepares before the auction opens.
2. Qualification and Selection, where the rules on who may compete and how winners are chosen are set.
3. Remuneration and Risk, where the contract terms determine who carries which risk and for how long.
4. Shock and Response, where a disruptive event tests the resilience of the design.

Each round presents realistic policy dilemmas and forces participants to weigh trade-offs between bankability, fiscal sustainability, consumer affordability, and local value creation.

A closing epilogue reports the outcome of the design a decade later, together with each stakeholder's final verdict. In extended sessions, this epilogue is replaced by a fifth round addressing post-award accountability and provisions for the end of contract. Appendix 2 provides a detailed overview of each round, including participant briefings, contextual background, and decision-making options.

Appendices

Appendix 1: Key Stakeholders

Finance Ministry

Guardian of fiscal sustainability and sovereign risk exposure

The Finance Ministry is accountable for the fiscal consequences of the auction. It issues or withholds sovereign guarantees, and it carries the contingent liabilities that credit enhancement creates. In offshore wind these exposures are unusually large: the capital sums involved are sufficient to affect sovereign debt metrics if guarantees are called, and hard currency power purchase agreements transfer exchange rate risk onto the public balance sheet for twenty years or more. Its non-negotiables are debt sustainability, a defensible ceiling on contingent liabilities, and legal review of any undertaking issued in the name of the state.

Energy Ministry

Programme sponsor accountable for capacity targets and delivery timelines

The Energy Ministry sponsors the offshore wind programme and owns its targets. It is accountable for delivering capacity against national objectives and NDC commitments, and it is acutely sensitive to political timelines that are shorter than offshore project development cycles. It must also coordinate the ministries and agencies whose consent offshore wind requires, spanning maritime spatial planning, environmental permitting, port development, and grid connection. Its core concerns are programme momentum, credible auction volumes, and avoiding a failed or undersubscribed round that would set the programme back by years.

State Utility

Offtaker and grid connection authority with a constrained balance sheet

The State Utility is the likely counterparty to the power purchase agreement and the entity responsible for grid connection. Its balance sheet is rarely strong enough to absorb payment obligations of this scale, and in many systems the cash it collects does not cover operating and capital costs – which makes counterparty risk the first question international bidders ask. It is also exposed to curtailment and transmission delay liabilities. Its non-negotiables are payment obligations it can realistically meet, tariff arrangements that do not erode its revenue base, and grid commitments matched to funded infrastructure.

Independent Regulator

Guardian of procedural integrity, tariff legality, and consumer affordability

The Independent Regulator approves tariffs and rules on the legality of the procurement. It examines whether the auction was conducted transparently, whether selection criteria were applied as published, and whether the resulting tariff is justified and lawful. It also carries a statutory duty towards consumers: costs not borne by the treasury are passed through to end users, and the regulator is the institution required to test whether that pass-through is affordable and proportionate. Its non-negotiables are procedural transparency, quantifiable and published scoring methodologies, and tariffs it can defend publicly.

International Offshore Wind Developer

Global developer whose participation the programme depends on

The International Offshore Wind Developer represents the small pool of companies able to deliver offshore wind at scale, allocating capital across a global pipeline on the basis of rigorous hurdle rate analysis. It reads every design choice as a risk allocation: qualification requirements, currency denomination, contract duration, curtailment provisions, and the creditworthiness of the offtaker all enter its bid price - or its decision not to bid at all. Its non-negotiables are a bankable revenue stream, enforceable contracts, and a procurement process it can trust. Its strongest sanction is simply to stay away.

Development Finance Institution

Provider of concessional capital, credit enhancement, and technical credibility

The Development Finance Institution brings concessional finance, guarantees, and the institutional weight that can catalyse commercial participation. Its role is particularly important in offshore wind, where commercial lenders are reluctant to take construction risk in unproven markets. It can extend loan tenors that match asset lifetimes, backstop liquidity, and support lending in local currency. It also applies environmental and social performance standards that are frequently more demanding than national regulation. Its non-negotiables are demonstrable additionality, compliance with those standards, and a risk allocation that does not simply transfer costs to the host government.

Coastal Communities and Fishing Industry

Holders of the social licence for offshore development

Coastal Communities and the Fishing Industry represent the people whose livelihoods and marine environment the programme affects. Offshore wind installations occupy fishing grounds, cross navigation routes, and alter marine ecosystems, and the communities

affected are rarely those that capture the economic benefit. Their engagement determines whether permits proceed unchallenged or are contested in the courts. Their core expectations are meaningful consultation before decisions are taken rather than after, credible benefit-sharing arrangements, independent assessment of ecological impacts, and compensation frameworks agreed with them rather than announced to them.

Domestic Industry and Supply Chain Advocate

Voice of the domestic industrial development interest

The Domestic Industry and Supply Chain Advocate speaks for the ports, steel fabricators, logistics companies, engineering firms, and vessel operators that could eventually capture value from an offshore wind programme. The offshore supply chain is concentrated among a small number of international manufacturers, so domestic participation occurs only where the auction design deliberately creates it - through local content requirements, port investment commitments, and a visible pipeline of future rounds that justifies building capacity. Its core concerns are sequencing that domestic firms can realistically meet, and continuity: a programme that halts after a single round strands whatever capacity was built to serve it.

Appendix 2: Serious Game Levels

Round 1: Enabling Conditions - Building the Ground Before the Auction

Briefing

Your government has committed to five gigawatts of offshore wind by 2035. Nothing has yet been procured, and no offshore project has been built in your waters. Before a single bid can be submitted, you must decide what the state prepares and what it leaves to the market.

As the cross-government auctioning authority, you must settle the architecture of the programme: who secures the seabed, who pays for grid connection and port capacity, and what enabling work is completed before the round opens. These choices set the cost of everything that follows.

Elements of Context

Offshore wind cannot be procured in isolation from the conditions that make projects deliverable. Seabed rights, marine spatial planning, port capacity, transmission reinforcement, and resource data all sit outside the auction itself, yet they determine whether bids arrive and whether awarded projects are ever built.

Every element the state prepares lowers developer risk and lowers bid prices - and raises public spending and fiscal exposure. Every element left to the market does the reverse. There is no neutral option here: the enabling conditions you decline to fund become risks that someone else prices, delays, or refuses to carry.

1. Provide the Development Site (Choose one)

How much site preparation will the state undertake before the auction?

- ☐ Pre-develop a single zone - state secures seabed, permits, grid access, and resource data
- ☐ Designate zones with guidance - capacity limits steer bidders towards prepared areas
- ☐ Leave siting to bidders - developers identify and secure their own sites
- ☐ Pre-develop one zone now, opening siting to bidders in later rounds

2. Allocate the Cost of Enabling Infrastructure (Choose one)

Who pays for grid connection, transmission reinforcement, and port upgrades?

- ☐ The state funds enabling infrastructure from the public budget
- ☐ Developers fund their own connection and contribute to shared works
- ☐ Costs are shared - the state builds transmission, developers fund connection
- ☐ Costs are recovered through the tariff and passed on to consumers

3. Commit Pre-Auction Preparations (Choose all that apply)

Which preparatory work will you complete and publish before the round opens?

- ☒ Complete and publish a marine spatial plan for the designated zones
- ☒ Fund a multi-year wind resource measurement campaign and release the data
- ☒ Commit public financing to port upgrades and heavy-lift capacity
- ☒ Reinforce transmission to the landing points on a published schedule

4. Volume of the First Round (Slider: 1-10)

How much capacity will you put to auction in this first round?

- ☐ 1 = 250 MW pilot - test the market before committing
- ☐ 10 = The full programme in a single round - maximum scale, maximum exposure

Round 2: Qualification and Selection – Deciding Who Competes and Who Wins

Briefing

The architecture is set and the round is announced. You must now decide who is permitted to bid, and on what basis you will choose between them.

The pool of developers able to deliver offshore wind at scale is small and selective about where it commits capital. Every requirement you impose narrows that pool further. Every requirement you waive admits bidders who may not deliver.

Elements of Context

Qualification requirements are your principal instrument against underbidding and non-delivery. Requiring lender commitments, completed environmental assessments, or a documented track record filters out speculative bids – and it deters smaller and domestic firms, reducing competition and raising prices.

Selection criteria declare your priorities publicly. Price-only awards are simple, defensible, and tend to favour large international developers. Multi-criteria awards can reward local content, system integration, and community benefit, but they demand transparent scoring that your regulator can uphold and that unsuccessful bidders cannot successfully challenge.

1. Set Qualification Requirements (Choose all that apply)

What must bidders submit for a bid to be considered?

- ☒ Lender commitment letters or signed loan term sheets
- ☒ A completed environmental and social impact assessment
- ☒ A documented offshore wind delivery track record
- ☒ A partnership or joint venture with a domestic firm

2. Choose the Winner Selection Criteria (Choose one)

On what basis will winning bids be selected?

- ☐ Lowest price only
- ☐ Price, with technical and financial criteria applied as pass or fail
- ☐ Multi-criteria scoring with published weights, price dominant
- ☐ Multi-criteria scoring including socio-economic commitments

3. Sequence the Local Content Requirement (Choose one)

How will you require domestic participation in the supply chain?

- ☐ Impose no local content requirement in this round
- ☐ Set a fixed local content share from the first round
- ☐ Start low and escalate across successive rounds on a published schedule
- ☐ Award bid points for local content rather than mandating a share

Round 3: Remuneration and Risk - Making the Project Bankable

Briefing

Bids will be priced against the contract you offer. You must now decide what currency that contract is denominated in, how sellers are paid, what the state stands behind, and for how long.

This is where bankability is won or lost - and where every protection you grant investors becomes an obligation carried by the treasury, the utility, or the ratepayer.

Elements of Context

Each of these choices removes a risk from the developer and places it somewhere else. Hard currency contracts remove exchange rate risk from investors and transfer it to the public balance sheet for the life of the agreement. Sovereign guarantees remove offtaker risk and create contingent liabilities that affect sovereign debt metrics if they are ever called.

The bids you receive will reflect what you offer. A design that protects investors comprehensively will attract competitive prices, and the cost of that protection does not disappear. It is deferred - and it is paid by someone who is not in the room when the auction closes.

1. Denominate the Contract (Choose one)

In what currency will the power purchase agreement be denominated?

- ☐ Hard currency, with the state absorbing exchange rate risk
- ☐ Local currency indexed to the exchange rate
- ☐ Local currency, unindexed
- ☐ Split denomination - part hard currency, part local

2. Select the Remuneration Model (Choose one)

How will winning projects be paid for the power they produce?

- ☐ Fixed-price power purchase agreement with a take-or-pay clause
- ☐ Two-way contract for difference - sellers refund revenue above the strike price
- ☐ One-way contract for difference - sellers retain revenue above the strike price
- ☐ Fixed premium paid on top of market revenue

3. Offer Credit Enhancement (Choose all that apply)

What will you provide to secure the revenue stream against offtaker default?

- ☒ A sovereign guarantee covering the utility's payment obligations
- ☒ A letter of credit or escrow account covering six months of invoices
- ☒ A liquidity facility supported by a development finance institution
- ☒ A put and call option agreement in place of termination clauses

4. Set the Contract Duration (Slider: 1-10)

How long will the power purchase agreement run?

- ☐ 1 = 15 years - shorter public exposure, higher bid prices
- ☐ 10 = 30 years - lower bid prices, obligations spanning several governments

Round 4: Shock and Response - Testing What You Built

Briefing

The auction is underway and your design is public. A disruptive event now tests it. One of the following has occurred:

A major international developer announces its withdrawal from the round, citing insufficient revenue certainty and unresolved grid connection risk. Or a fishing community federation launches a legal challenge to the zone designation, citing inadequate consultation and unacceptable impacts on traditional fishing grounds. Or the Finance Ministry, facing a sovereign credit rating review, withdraws its support for the guarantee structure the programme was built around. Or a currency depreciation materially changes the economics of projects already in the pipeline.

You must respond - and you must be seen to respond.

Elements of Context

This round introduces no new design elements. It tests the ones you have already chosen. Every protection you granted and every risk you left unallocated is now visible, and the stakeholders who warned you will remember whether they were heard.

Stakeholders react to the substance of your response and to the manner of it - whether you acknowledge the problem, whether you demonstrate institutional credibility, and whether your response reveals that the design was more fragile than it appeared. A technically sound answer delivered defensively can cost more support than a costly one delivered openly.

1. Choose Your Primary Response (Choose one)

How will you respond to the event?

- ☐ Restructure the risk allocation to retain developer participation
- ☐ Engage the affected community directly, accepting delay for a stronger social licence
- ☐ Seek emergency support from development finance institutions
- ☐ Delay the round and rebuild the enabling conditions

2. Set the Communication Posture (Choose one)

How will you communicate your response to markets, communities, and the public?

- ☐ Acknowledge the problem openly and publish the revised terms in full
- ☐ Issue a technical reassurance that the fundamentals are unchanged
- ☐ Defer to process - confirm that established procedures are being followed
- ☐ Say nothing publicly until the response has been finalised

3. Accompanying Measures (Choose all that apply)

What will you put in place alongside your primary response?

- ☒ Extend the bid deadline and adjust the project timetable
- ☒ Convene the affected stakeholders in a formal consultation
- ☒ Commission an independent review of the contested decision

- ✓ Adjust penalties and delivery obligations for awarded projects

Epilogue: Ten Years On - The Verdict

Contracts were awarded and a decade has passed. No further decisions are available.

Participants are shown the outcome their design produced: whether awarded projects reached commercial operation and at what capacity, whether port investments and local content commitments materialised, what the programme cost the treasury, what it added to the tariff, and where the risk allocation map finally settled.

Each of the eight stakeholders then delivers a closing verdict on whether the auction design served their interests and produced a programme worth sustaining. The cumulative satisfaction scores and the final risk allocation map combine into an overall outcome assessment - not a binary win or loss, but a profile of what the design achieved and what it cost, and to whom.

Round 5: Post-Award Accountability - What the Design Deferred

The following round is used in the longer version of the exercise, in place of the epilogue above.

Briefing

Contracts were awarded and construction is underway. Some commitments have been met and others have not. The port upgrade is behind schedule, local content reporting is contested, and one project has missed its commercial operation date.

You must decide how to enforce what was promised, and what happens to these assets when the contracts eventually expire.

Elements of Context

This is where auction design meets its consequences. Penalty regimes are routinely eased in practice, because auctioneers fear that enforcing them will jeopardise the very projects they were meant to protect. Waiving them teaches every future bidder what your commitments are worth.

The contracts you signed run beyond the term of the government that signed them. Decisions about ownership, decommissioning, and what follows the power purchase agreement determine whether these assets remain a national resource or become a liability inherited by people who had no part in the auction.

1. Enforce Unmet Obligations (Choose one)

How will you respond to commitments that have not been delivered?

- Enforce the penalty regime as written

- ☐ Renegotiate deadlines in exchange for strengthened commitments
- ☐ Waive penalties against an agreed and monitored mitigation plan
- ☐ Initiate termination proceedings on the non-performing project

2. Determine Asset Ownership at End of Contract (Choose one)

What happens to the assets when the power purchase agreements expire?

- ☐ Build-own-operate - the project company retains ownership indefinitely
- ☐ Build-own-operate-transfer - ownership reverts to the state
- ☐ Transfer to the state, then re-auction the concession competitively
- ☐ Defer the decision to a review five years before expiry

3. Long-Term Provisions (Choose all that apply)

Which arrangements will you put in place for the end of asset life?

- ☒ Require a funded decommissioning reserve from the outset
- ☒ Assign decommissioning responsibility to the seller
- ☒ Grant repowering rights subject to renewed consent
- ☒ Permit merchant sales into the market after the contract expires

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Disclosure: Use of AI Technologies

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